

Production: At the core, a project is lead by a producer who supports the project. Like a typical project manager, the production manager's tasks involve budgeting, meeting the requirements of various departments, documentation of reports, and keeping track of project progress. Knowledge of and exposure to design, programming, and visual arts help in their work.

Audio: Professional music composers, candidates with a sound engineering degree, and SFX artists can work in an audio and sound effects team. The background score and the special effects are added to match the graphics, gameplay, and storyline of the game. Sound engineers and artists should have had hands-on skills working with software like Sound Forge, Cubase, Bink, Miles, and such.

We've already spoken about game testing. It is very similar to software testing and validation. Individuals from a software testing and validation background would be a perfect fit for this segment.

Candidates with a business management or management studies degree are the ideal choice for business functions within the gaming industry. Besides activities towards growth and expansion of the business nationally, they look at international tie-ups.

Essential Gear

Many game development companies encourage their employees to play games in their free time, or even during office hours. "The gaming industry firmly believes that those who don't play games can't visualise for better game ideation," says Rohit Sharma, CEO, Zapak.com, a casual gaming portal.

"Passion for gaming is treated as a value-add in reference to the specific function in game development. A good balance between a passion for gaming and the capability to perform the assigned task helps bring out the best", adds George.

We've already spoken about the required educational backgrounds. "Surprisingly, the game masters come from varied backgrounds—from microbiology to commerce," says Naveen H, national manager for gaming, Sify, an online portal that also offers Web domain services and runs game-dromes.

A graduate degree or a diploma is essential for any professional segment. If you're looking at a serious education in gaming, several universities in the US, the UK, Australia, and other countries offer specialised degree and diploma courses in specific aspects of game development.

"Producers could benefit hugely with an all-round knowledge of art, programming, and design along with project management," informs Sharma.

Certification

The demand-supply gap in the industry is very wide as of now. "No exposure, lack of knowledge about gaming as a profession, and unavailability of good training schools are the factors that affect the demand-supply gap in the gaming industry," says D'Silva.



Gaming is about technology, action scripting, and so on, but equally, it is about gameplay and creativity"

Carlton D'Silva
Creative Director
Hungama

No courses focusing specifically on game development are available. "India could definitely benefit from courses for game-related functions, especially if they are well-structured and offer an insight into how games are developed, how technology enables the industry, and also provide a background into the industry and the career options within it," says Raman.

What's required is collaboration with international animation and gaming institutes, along with government recognition of curricula for graduate and Masters programs meeting global standards.

Rewards And Credits

Any rewards and/or credits, like in any other occupation, are given on the basis of individual performance as well as performance in a team effort.

Here is a snapshot of how much you can expect to earn. Though it is a niche market of about 50 employers, the remuneration varies across organisations. The ranges mentioned below are aggregated, indicative, and on a per-month basis.

Approximate Remuneration Matrix (per month)			
Department	Entry Level	Middle Level	Top Level
Design	Rs 10,000–30,000	Rs 30,000–45,000	Rs 45,000 and above
Production	Rs 12,000–25,000	Rs 25,000–40,000	Rs 40,000 and above
Programming	Rs 15,000–35,000	Rs 35,000–60,000	Rs 60,000 and above
Visual Arts	Rs 12,000–30,000	Rs 30,000–50,000	Rs 50,000 and above
Audio	Rs 10,000–15,000	Rs 15,000–30,000	Rs 30,000 and above
Business development and allied operations	Rs 6,000–20,000	Rs 20,000–45,000	Rs 45,000 and above
Testing	Rs 10,000–30,000	Rs 30,000–50,000	Rs 50,000 and above

These figures can be expected to go up by 10 to 50 per cent on the basis of the market situation and demand-supply ratio.

Future Prospects

Gaming is expected to be the next big thing in the entertainment industry. "India, with its cost-effectiveness and availability of skilled resource pool, is already a preferred destination among the global players. Now, with prestigious international developers setting up development centres on Indian shores, the scope of opportunities is simply vast," says Ninad Chhaya, executive vice president—operations and production, Jump Games, who offer game content development services. According to the NASSCOM report, *Animation and Gaming in India 2007*, the Indian gaming industry for the year 2006 was nearly Rs 48 crore, and by 2010, it is expected to surpass Rs 424 crore.

With all three major gaming consoles now available in India, the three companies producing the consoles will look for local game developers who can work on projects at a global scale.

Industry stalwarts and the available figures say it out loud—game on, people. Grab your controllers! ☒

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